

EXCLUSIVE

IAS PRELIMS 2026

CURRENT AFFAIRS

REVISION

GS-1 (DYNAMIC)

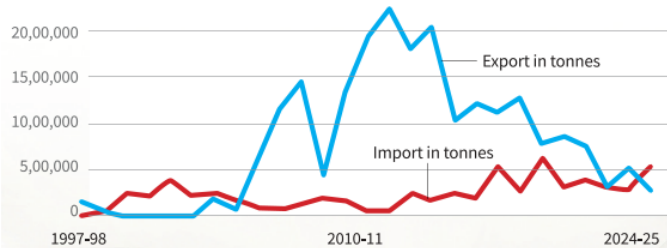
MODULE - 35



**MISCELLANEOUS
EVENTS - 4**

In 2024-25, Indian cotton imports were higher than that of cotton exports!

Chart 2: The chart shows the export and import of raw cotton (including waste) in India between 1997-98 and 2024-25, in tonnes. In 2024-25, imports touched 5 lakh tonnes—a 77 % jump from the previous year



The textile sector, one of the biggest employers, is witnessing the reduction of women garment-workers, as global apparel brands shift the burden of higher tariffs onto supply chains in the Global South.

1 India's R&D spending is among the lowest in the developing world. An uncompetitive sector could push farmers towards unsustainable crops.

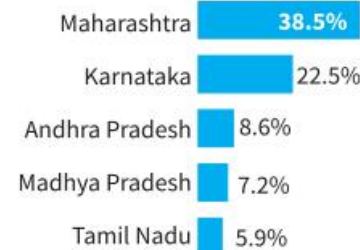
2 More imports mean declining price parity: domestic cotton is costlier, while global prices are falling.

Maharashtra and Karnataka account for more than 60% of the suicides of farmers and agricultural workers.

Fields of despair

The lives of 10,786 farmers and agricultural workers were lost to suicide in 2023, according to the NCRB report

STATE-WISE FIGURES



A large number of farmer suicides take place in the cotton and soybean belt in Maharashtra.

Spatial variations is the real concern for Indian monsoon.

Tracking monsoon

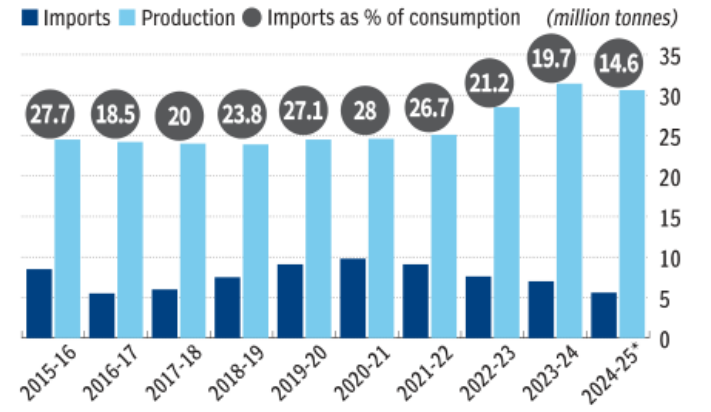
From June 1 to September 30 (in millimetres)

Region	Actual	Normal	% departure
All-India	937.2	868.6	7.9
North-west India	747.9	587.6	27.3
East and north-east India	1089.9	1367.3	-20.3
Central India	1125.3	978	15.1
South peninsular India	787.4	716.2	9.9

Source: India Metereological Department (IMD)

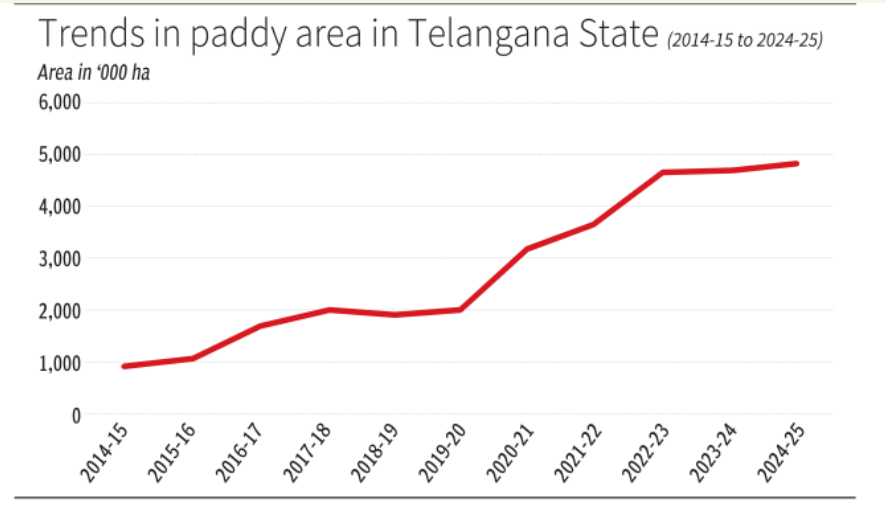
This slide gives idea about the trends in urea production and imports.

Trends in urea production and imports



*Provisional figures Source: Fertilizer Association of India, CACP

Paddy cultivation in Telangana has increased tremendously during the previous decade.



India has around 100-billion-dollar trade deficit with China.

Nearby scenario

India's trade with key neighbouring countries in FY25 (\$ bn)

Country	Exports	Imports	Total trade
China	14.25	113.45	127.7
Bangladesh	11.48	2	13.48
Nepal	7.38	1.29	8.67
Sri Lanka	4.55	1.3	5.85
Pakistan	0.56	0.0005	0.5605
Bhutan	1.26	0.64	1.9

Source: Department of Commerce

This slide is a snapshot on cough syrup deaths during the past five years.

Other countries suffer from faulty Indian drugs too

Child fatalities elsewhere from Indian cough syrup

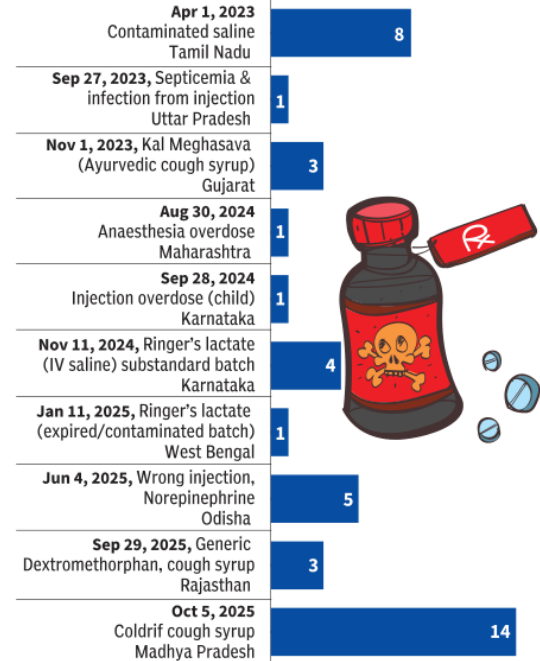
Year	Deaths of children	Cause	Country
2022	66	Cough syrups (manufactured by Maiden Pharmaceuticals)	The Gambia
2022	65	Cough syrups (manufactured by Marion Biotech)	Uzbekistan
2023	10	Cough syrups (manufactured in India)	Cameroon

Source: Media reports

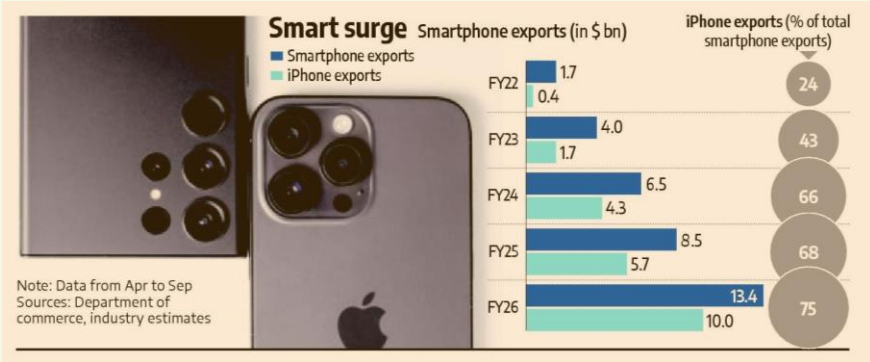
Consequence of medical negligence

Most deaths from cough syrups

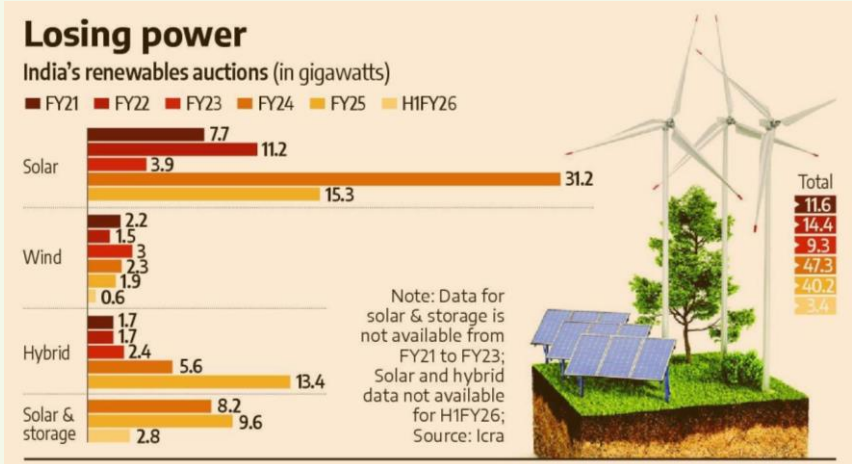
Major cases of deaths in India since April 2023 due to medical negligence or malpractice



smartphone exports skyrocketed in India during the past five years.



This is a snapshot on renewable power auctions during the past five years.



Huge surplus in services and huge inward foreign remittances are keeping India's current account deficit at comfort levels.

Steady growth in **exports**



Merchandise and services exports together grew **4.45%** in April-September, outpacing import rise and narrowing the trade gap by **2.3%**

		April-September 2024-25 (US\$ Billion)	April-September 2025-26 (US\$ Billion)	Change in %
Merchandise	Exports	213.68	220.12	3.02
	Imports	358.85	375.11	4.53
Services*	Exports	182.03	193.18	6.12
	Imports	97.73	97.68	-0.05

*The latest data for services sector released by RBI is for August 2025. The data for September 2025 is an estimation

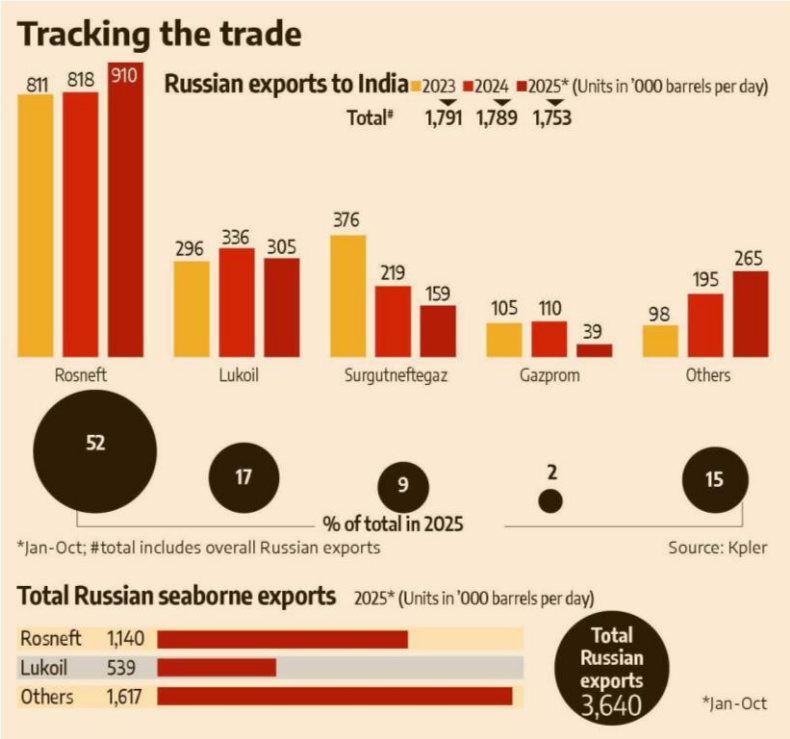
SOURCE: MINISTRY OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY

Actual devolution of central taxes to States has fallen to 31% of GTR during the 15th FC period.

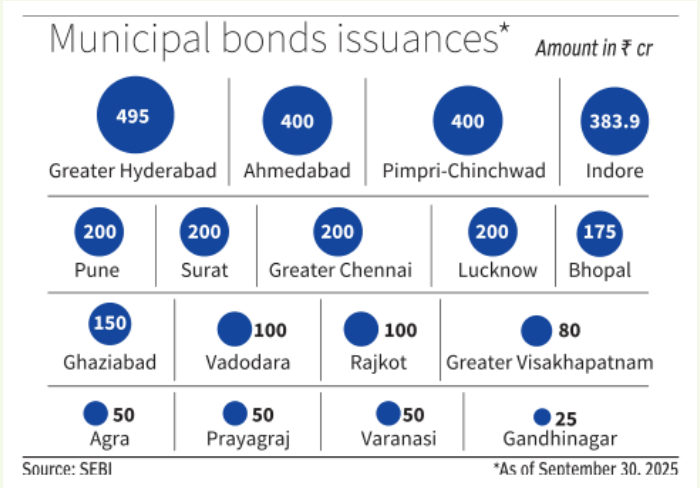
Table 1 shows how the actual devolution of Central taxes to States has fallen short

Finance Commission	Recommended share on shareable pool (in %)	Actual share on GTR (in %)
13Th FC	32	28
14th FC	42	32
15th FC up to 2023-24	41	31

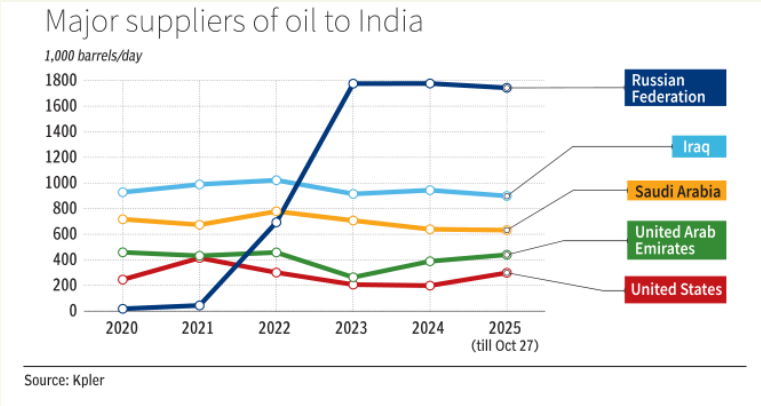
Recently, USA imposed sanctions on Rosneft and Lukoil.



Municipal bond issuances in India is still at its infancy!



These are the prominent crude oil suppliers to India.



Passport power still dominated by high-income economies ... Indian passport has visa-free destinations only for 57.

India's passport rank has stagnated over a decade

Ranks in (brackets) ▶

India's ranking has seen only marginal improvement since 2015, despite growing diplomatic outreach and trade ties. In 2015, Indian citizens could travel visa-free to 52 destinations; in 2025, that number is 57 — a modest gain of just five in 10 years. The rank has fluctuated between 81st and 90th, with no sustained upward trend, showing that India's mobility has not kept pace with its economic growth.

Note: Ranking is out of 199 countries
Source: Henley and Partners

Year	Rank	Visa-free destinations
2015	(88)	52
2016	(85)	52
2017	(87)	49
2018	(81)	60
2019	(82)	59
2020	(82)	58
2021	(90)	58
2022	(83)	60
2023	(84)	60
2024	(80)	62
2025	(85)	57

Sugar exports reduced significantly after diverting sugarcane-based products into manufacture of ethanol ... now, Maize is occupying the prime position in ethanol production.

BCCI introduced equal match fees in 2022, but there is a huge difference in the annual BCCI contract amount for men and women.

Looking up

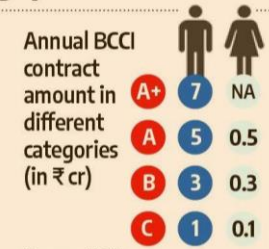
Sugar exports (Oct to Sep) in million tonnes



*expected Source: Government of India and millers

Persistent pay gap

While the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) introduced equal match fees for men and women cricketers in 2022, there is a stark difference in the annual contracts.



Source: BCCI

Note: There is no A+ contract for women cricketers. Cricketers with an A+ contract are Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli, Jasprit Bumrah and Ravindra Jadeja. Women cricketers with an A category contract as of today are Harmanpreet Kaur, Smriti Mandhana and Deepti Sharma.

This slide gives idea about weightages in Consumer Price Index basket.

What pulled inflation down

Deflation in food & beverages led record low inflation in October 2025

Core group inflation sorted by weight in combined CPI basket

Core group	y-o-y inflation (%)	Weight
Food & beverages	-3.7	45.9
Housing	3.0	10.1
Transport & communication	0.9	8.6
Fuel & light	2.0	6.8
Clothing & footwear	1.7	6.5
Health	3.9	5.9
Education	3.5	4.5
Personal care & effects	23.9	3.9
Household goods & services	2.3	3.8
Pan, tobacco and intoxicants	2.9	2.4
Recreation & amusement	1.5	1.7
General CPI (All groups)	0.25	

Hyderabad has become the most favorable destination for GCCs in India, overtaking Bengaluru.

Hyderabad overtakes Bengaluru to become top GCC destination

Hyderabad has overtaken Bengaluru to become the leading destination for GCCs in India, supported by cost advantage, infrastructure, and pro-business ecosystem, according to a study by UneathInsights. The state accounted for 46 per cent of all new GCCs, while Bengaluru captured 33 per cent in January-November 2025.

Breakup of GCCs added this year

Top global names—
Vanguard, StarRez, T-Mobile, Goodyear, and more have set up or scaled up in India this year.

Total GCCs set up during this period: 85-95

60+

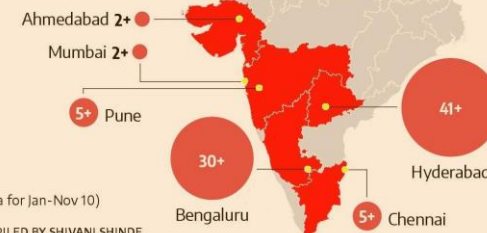
GCCs entrants

25+

Existing GCCs expansion

(Data for Jan-Nov 10)

COMPILED BY SHIVANI SHINDE



This slide gives idea about the import of edible oils by India during the past five years.

Import of edible oil *(November-October)*

Year	2024-25	2023-24	2022-23	2021-22	2020-21
Quantity <i>(in lakh tonnes)</i>	160.1	159.6	164.7	140.3	131.3
Value in ₹ lakh cr <i>(Est)</i>	1.6	1.3	1.4	1.6	1.2
Value in \$ billion <i>(Est)</i>	18.3	15.9	16.6	19.6	15.6

Bumper harvest in Kharif season of 2025-26

Robust growth *(in lakh tonnes)*

	Kharif 2024 (Final estimates)	Kharif 2025 (First advance estimates)
Rice	1,227.72	1,245.04
Maize	248.08	283.03
Nutricereals	389.56	414.14
Total pulses	77.33	74.13
Tur	36.24	35.97
Urad	13.41	12.05
Moong	17.74	17.20
Total foodgrains	1,694.60	1,733.30
Groundnut	104.12	110.93
Soybean	152.68	142.66
Sugarcane	4,564.11	4,756.14
Cotton*	297.24	292.15
Jute & Mesta#	88.02	83.45



*Lakh bales of 170 kg each #Lakh bales of 180 kg each

50% non-fossil power generation capacity target achieved by India much ahead of 2030.

5

50% non-fossil power target achieved ahead of 2030

Non-fossil fuel energy capacity in 2025

Sector	Non-fossil fuel energy (in Gw)	Grand total (in Gw)	% Share of non-fossil fuel energy in total
State	30.01	111.08	27.02
Private	185.49	266.51	69.6
Central	27.19	108.53	25.05
Total	242.69	484.82	50.06

* Data as on 30.06.2025; Note: Non-fossil fuel includes renewable and nuclear energy; Source: Central Electricity Authority, 2025

China, USA and India are the top GHG emitters, as per UNEP Emissions Gap Report.

World's largest Banks by assets ... four are in mainland China & India's SBI at 43rd rank.

World's largest banks by assets ranked by S&P Global (April 2025)

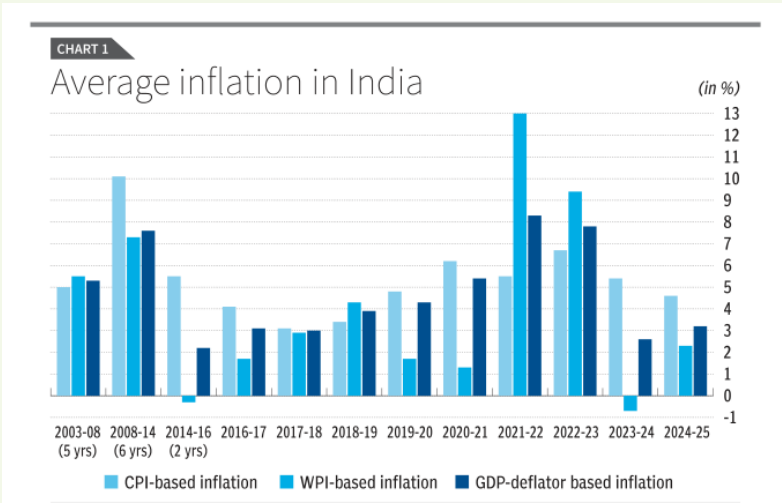
Present rank	Bank	Headquarters	Assets (\$ billion)
1	Industrial and Commercial Bank of China	Mainland China	6,688.74
2	Agricultural Bank of China	Mainland China	5,923.76
3	China Construction Bank Corp.	Mainland China	5,558.38
4	Bank of China	Mainland China	4,803.51
5	JPMorgan Chase & Co.	US	4,002.81
6	Bank of America Corp.	US	3,261.52
7	HSBC Holdings PLC	UK	2,989.81
8	BNP Paribas SA	France	2,809.83
9	Crédit Agricole Group	France	2,693.58
10	Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group	Japan	2,628.12
Indian banks in top 100			
43	State Bank of India	India	846.64
73	HDFC Bank Ltd	India	494.06

How Indian banking industry compares (March 2024)

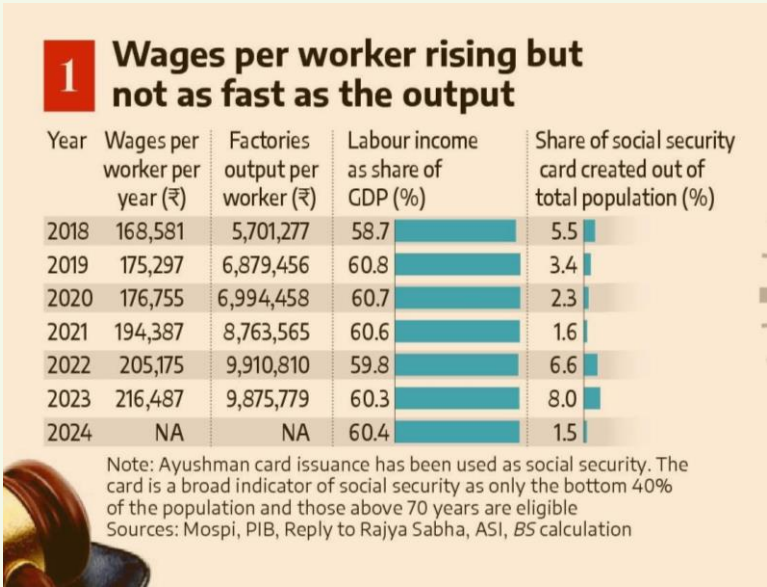
	Assets (\$ billion)
Total assets of all scheduled commercial banks in India	3,383.2
Total assets of public sector banks	1,866.7
Total assets of private sector banks	1,267.6

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence, RBI

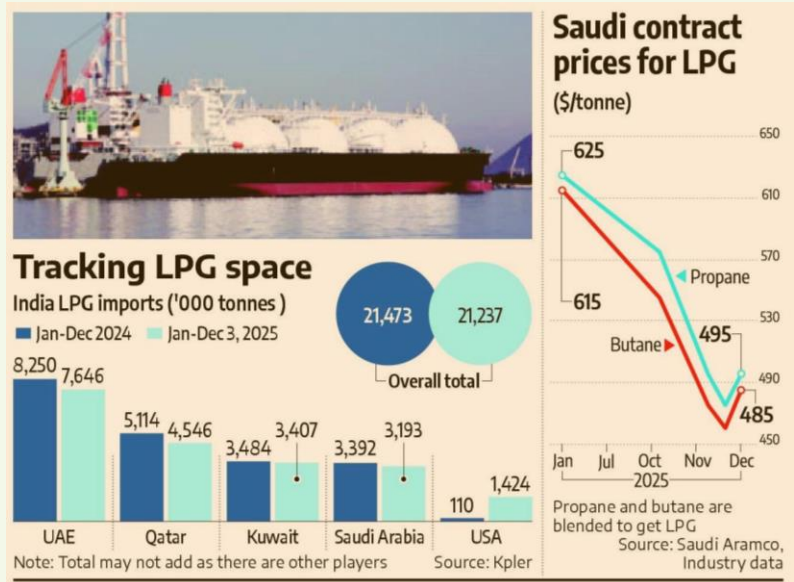
Benign inflation in 2025 ... Hence, Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) curtailed the repo rate by 125 basis points in calendar year 2025



In India, wage growth per worker per year is not commensurate with the factories output per worker!



India's largest importer of LPG is UAE



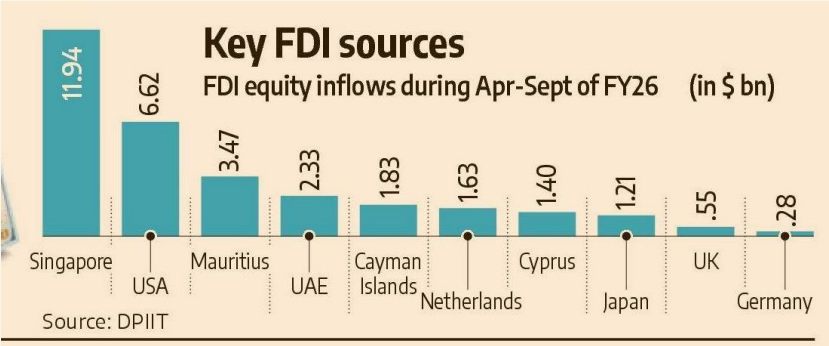
Gemini is now challenging the supremacy of ChatGPT

Riding the AI boom

Platform	No. of active users (mn)
ChatGPT	800*
Gemini	650
Grok (xAI)	30.1
Perplexity AI	22
Claude	18.9

*Average weekly users; others are approximate monthly user numbers
Note: These are global figures; approximately 10-12% of the users are in India
Source: Companies/DemandSage

This slide gives idea about FDI equity inflows to India from various countries



This slide gives idea about import of gold in tonnes

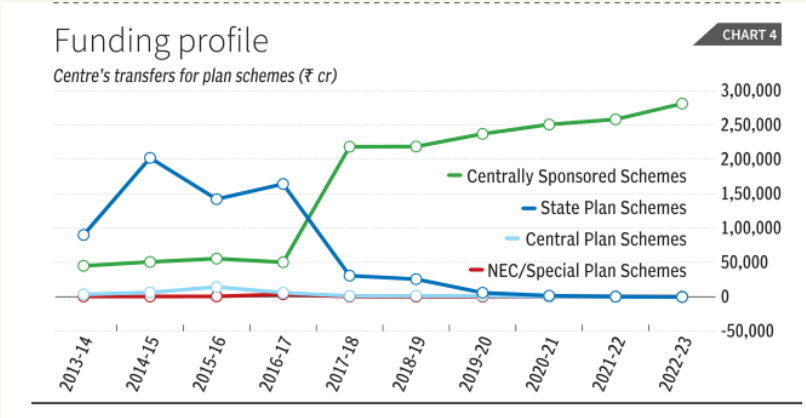
Smuggling patterns

Year	Import of gold (in tonnes)	Gold seizure by DRI (in kg)	Gold seizure by CBIC (in kg)
2022-23	678.3	1,452	4,869.6
2023-24	795.2	1,364	3,480.9
2024-25	669.3	1,073	2,600



Source: DGCI&S, DRI

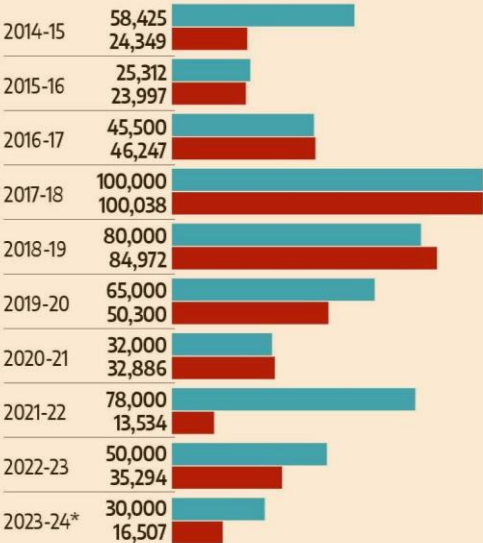
Out of the central transfers, other than tax sharing and grants, Central Government contribution is only for Centrally Sponsored Schemes.



Disinvestment is a major let down for India!

Falling short

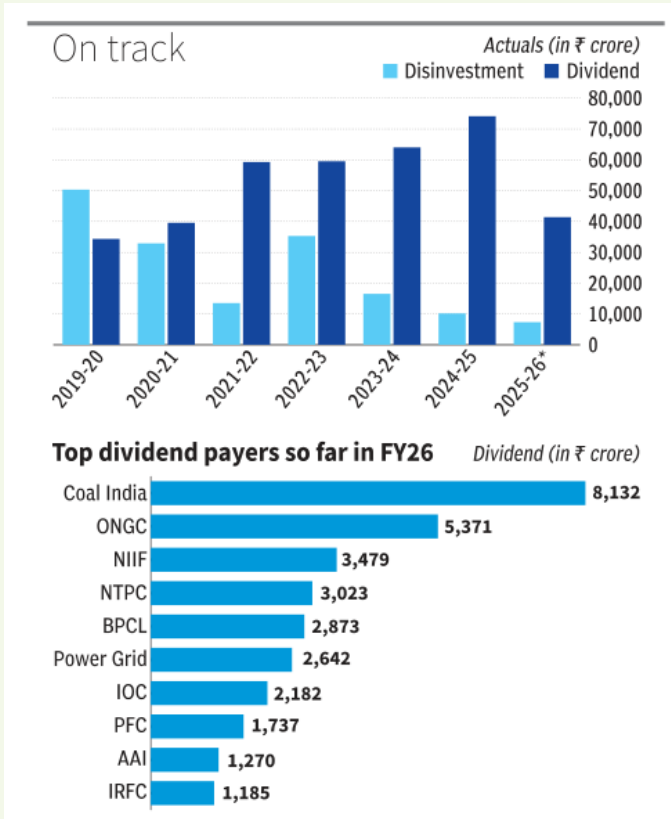
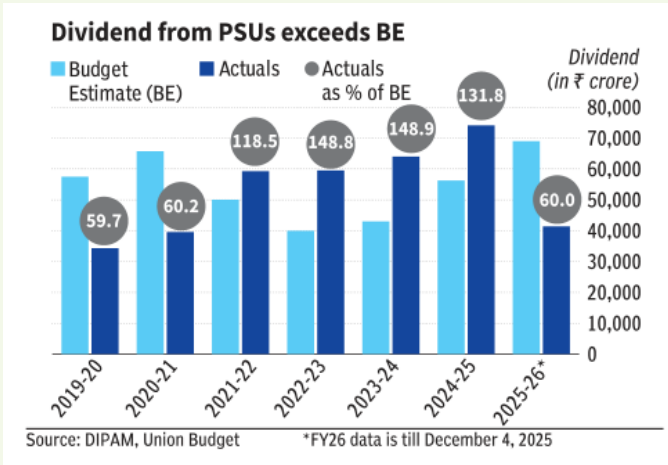
■ Disinvestment target ■ Actual disinvestment (₹ cr)



*Separate disinvestment target has been discontinued since the Revised Estimate (RE) stage of FY 2023- 24. Divestment receipts are now accounted for as a part of broader target of "Miscellaneous Capital Receipts"

Dis-investment is a major failure, where as dividend proceeds exceed Budget Estimates from the Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)

Space



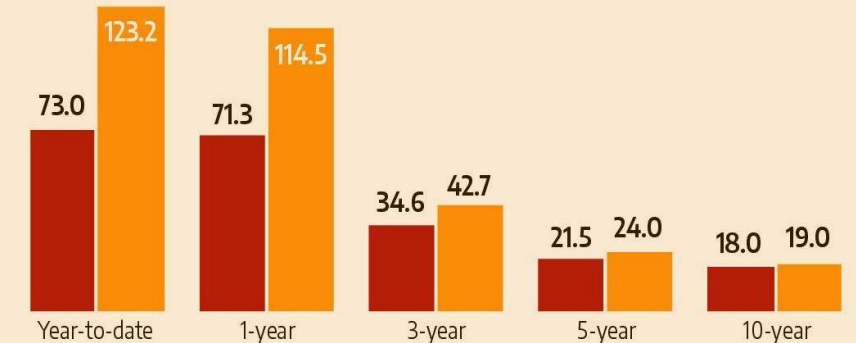
India imports silver primarily from UK and Hong Kong markets



Silver has outpaced gold across horizons

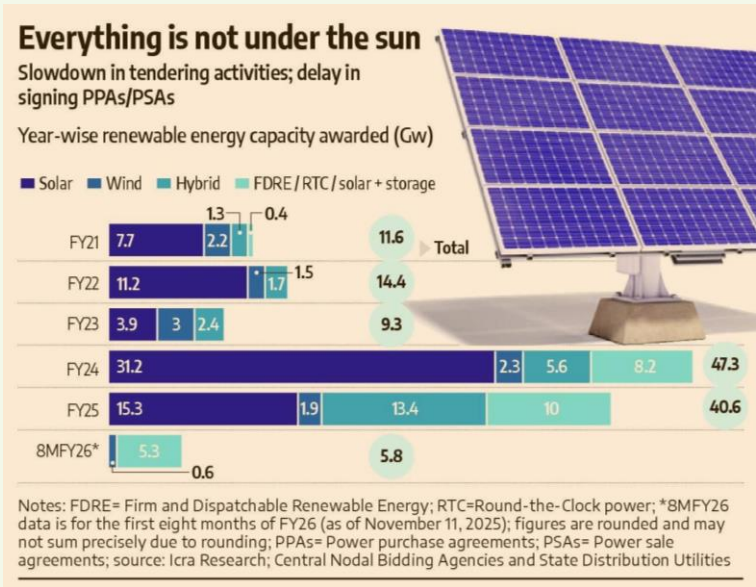
Silver has outpaced gold across horizons

Returns (%) ■ Gold ■ Silver

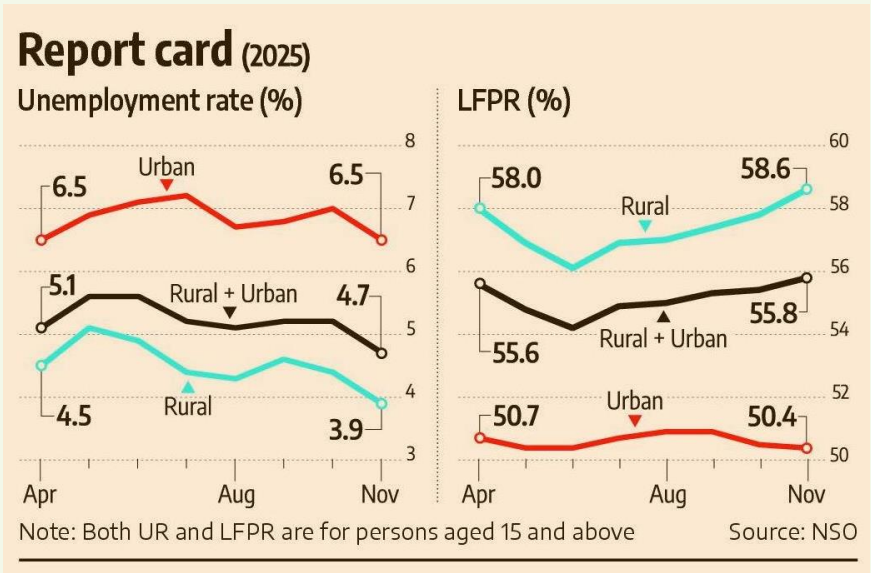


Source: Bloomberg; Compiled by BS Research

Now the trend is towards hybrid renewable energy plants with battery storage facilities.



Unemployment rate in urban areas is higher than that of rural areas.



Sharp rise in women's LFPR

Supply-demand mismatch

The sharp rise in women's LFPR has expanded supply faster than demand in the labour market, which partially explains the stagnation in women's labour income share and little change in employment rate.



Note: Women aged above 15 yrs are considered Source: Periodic Labour Force Surveys

These are some examples of anti-obesity drugs



Right dose

GLP-1 drug performance in India

Moving annual turnover (in ₹cr)

	November			
	'22*	'23	'24	'25
Anti-obesity mkt	242	411	567	1,109
Semaglutide	71	220	378	427
Rybelsus	71	220	378	377
Wegovy	NA	NA	NA	50
Mounjaro (tirzepatide)**	NA	NA	NA	496

Note: Wegovy and Mounjaro were launched in 2025

*For 12 mths between Oct 2021 and Nov 2022 and so on

**Separate molecule that mimics both GLP-1 & GIP enzymes

Source: PharmaTrac Nov 2025

IN 2025-26 (till October), coal based power generation accounted for 68%.

‘RE’defining capacity

Renewable energy (RE) additions are accelerating far faster than fossil fuels. In April-October period this year, only 3 GW of coal capacity was added. In contrast, RE additions hit 28 GW.

	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (till Oct)
Total	1,389	1,382	1,492	1,624	1,739	1,830	1104
Coal	1,043 (75%)	1,032 (74.67%)	1,115 (74.73%)	1,206 (74.25%)	1,326 (76.27%)	1,364 (74.54%)	753 (68.17%)
RE	294 (21.17%)	298 (21.56%)	323 (21.61%)	366 (22.51%)	360 (20.7%)	404 (22.06%)	312 (28.26%)

All figures are in billion kWhr; Notes: RE includes large hydro; the difference between coal+RE and the total is accounted for by nuclear and purchase of power from Bhutan

The fertilizer imports from Russia became four-fold since 2021-22.

Boosting nutrient needs

India’s fertiliser imports from Russia (in tonnes)

	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	CAGR (%)
Total Russian imports	1,191,000	1,915,000	1,102,000	3,856,000	4,815,000	22.01
Total all India imports	18,550,000	20,530,000	18,405,000	19,521,000	18,027,000	-26.55
Share (%)*	6.42	9.33	5.99	19.75	26.93	

*Share of fertiliser imports from Russia in relation to India’s total imports;

Sources: FAI, traders

Among India's merchandise goods exports, engineering goods contributes to the highest, followed by refined petroleum products and electronic goods.

Top in trade

Five leading segments in Indian exports

	Apr-Nov '25 (\$ bn)	Y-o-Y chg (%)
Engineering goods	79.7 	4.3
Petroleum products	37.9 	-14.7
Electronic goods	31.0 	38.0
Drugs and pharmaceuticals	20.4 	6.5
Gems & jewellery	19.1 	-0.6

Source: Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Chronological sequence of NREGA to VB-G RAM G

2005: NREGA enacted guaranteeing 100 days of wage employment

2006: Phase-I implementation in 200 rural districts

2007: Phase-II expansion to a total of 330 rural districts

2008: Universal coverage in rural districts

2009: Act renamed MGNREGA in honour of Mahatma Gandhi

2012: Wage indexation linked to CPI-AL with annual revision

2013: eFMS launched for DBT to workers' accounts

2015: Aadhaar-based biometric payments introduced

2016: GeoMGN-REGA initiative

launched for mandatory geo-tagging of assets

2019: Wage rate revision notified under Section 6(1)

2020: Covid-19 response with ₹1,01,500 crore allocation

2021: NMMS deployed for real-time, photo-based attendance capture

2022: West Bengal fund suspension due to non-compliance

2024: Highest ever Budget estimate allocation of ₹86,000 crore

2025: West Bengal funds resumed on December 6

2025: VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 proposes higher employment days and funding by states

These are the activities that are permitted through Liberalized Remittance Scheme (LRS) for resident individuals.

At a glance

Outward remittances under Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS) for resident individuals (\$ mn)

	Oct-25	Y-o-Y % chg	FY26	Y-o-Y % chg
Deposit	47.16	20.74	377.82	13.13
Purchase of immovable property	44.64	78.85	286.71	77.96
Investment in equity/debt	273.09	82.86	1,374.76	62.00
Gift	197.53	-8.68	1,521.28	-14.03
Donations	0.87	31.82	7.83	9.21
Travel	1,352.59	-7.02	9,976.4	-6.45
Maintenance of close relatives	273.86	-3.49	2,101.15	-4.54
Medical Treatment	5.04	-40.64	36.86	-35.46
Studies Abroad	163.26	-26.19	1,428.12	-21.79
Others	6.4	-33.47	53.64	-83.58
Total	2,364.45	-1.81	17,164.59	-4.75

Source: RBI

In India's software exports, the contours are shifting towards hi-tech exports

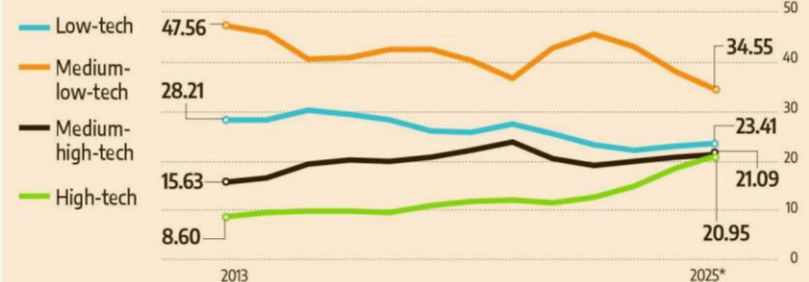
Tech trade portfolio

Share of India's exports by technology intensity (in %)

To the US



To the world



Note: *January-June

Sources: ITC Trade Map, Business Standard calculations

Global perspective of productivity and the right to disconnect.

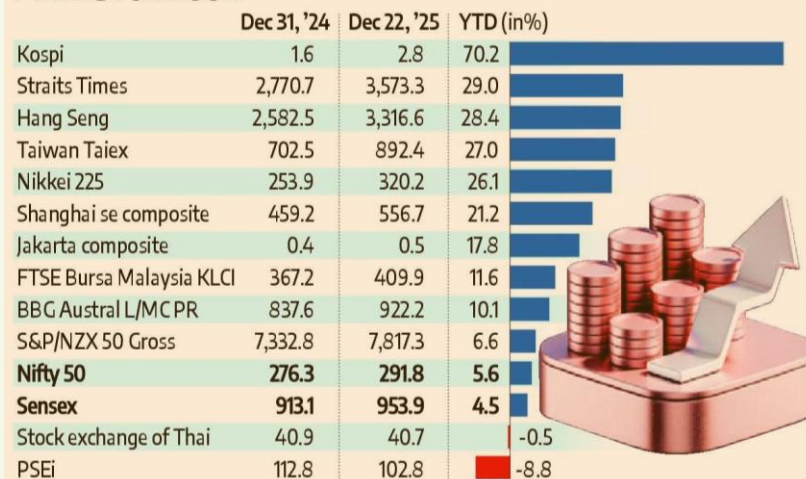
Productivity and the right to disconnect:
A global perspective

Country	RTD since	GDP per hour in \$	Productivity rank
Ireland	2021	164.65	1
Belgium	2022	91.54	9
France	2017	80.18	20
Australia	2024	71.81	29
Canada	2021	69.76	35
Kazakhstan	2022	41.52	76
Argentina	2021	33.81	91
Mexico	2023	22.71	133
Colombia	2022	18.31	159
Peru	2023	15.33	178
Philippines	2017	12.01	191
India	NA	10.98	198

Source: Xpheno

These are some of the stock indices globally.

Market outlook



Compiled by BS Research Bureau

Source: Bloomberg

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